higher education & training

Department:
Higher Education and Training
REPUBLIC OF SOUTH AFRICA

MARKING GUIDELINE

NATIONAL CERTIFICATE

SALES MANAGEMENT N6

13 NOVEMBER 2019

This marking guideline consists of 7 pages.

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SECTION A

QUESTION 1

1.1	1.1.1	H
	1.1.2	E
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	1.1.4	A
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	1.1.6	G
	1.1.7	D
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	1.1.9	I
	1.1.10	F

(10 × 2) (20)

1.2	1.2.1	True
	1.2.2	False
	1.2.3	False
	1.2.4	False
	1.2.5	False
	1.2.6	True
	1.2.7	True
	1.2.8	True
	1.2.9	False
	1.2.10	True
	1.2.11	False
	1.2.12	False
	1.2.13	False
	1.2.14	False
	1.2.15	True

(15 × 2) (30)
[50]

TOTAL SECTION A: 50

SECTION B

QUESTION 2

2.1 2.1.1

- Recruiting is the process of sourcing, finding and inviting qualified applicants to apply for a position in a company.
- Selection is the process in which managers choose to appoint an incumbent from the applicants who have been recruited, screened and evaluated. (2 × 3) (6)

- It is easier to evaluate internal applicants because more information is available about them.
- It is the least expensive recruiting method.
- It can improve employee morale and loyalty to company.
- It is quicker than an external search.
- The internal applicant is already familiar with company policies. (Any 4 × 2) (8)

2.1.3

- To collect information about the suitability of a candidate for a particular job.
- To ensure all information obtained from applicants is in order to make objective comparison possible.
- To save time, especially during the initial screening phase.
- To assist the sales manager to prepare for a personal interview with the candidate. (Any 3 × 2) (6)

2.2 2.2.1

- To motivate the sales force✓ – the better the compensation plan, the more motivated sales staff will be.✓✓
- To correlate efforts and results with rewards✓ – to match salespeople's efforts to sales territory potential.✓✓
- To ensure customers are properly treated✓ – a well-thought-out compensation plan will reward salespeople for maintaining customer satisfaction.✓✓
- To attract and maintain competent sales staff✓ – a well-designed compensation plan will attract competent staff and retain committed loyal employees over a long period.✓✓
- To ensure flexibility and stability✓ – a compensation plan should be flexible enough to accommodate the rapidly changing needs of a company and its people.✓✓
- To be economical and stay competitive✓ – a well-designed compensation plan should ensure that costs are controlled and should compare favourably with other competitors.✓✓

(Any 3 × 3) (9)

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2.2.2
- Salespeople want their earnings to be fair compared to what their colleagues earn.
- Their compensation must be on par with other salespeople in opposition companies.
- They expect compensation packages to keep pace with inflation and rising costs of living. (Any 2 × 2) (4)

2.2.3
- When team selling makes it difficult to identify individual sales efforts.
- Where there are large differences in sales potential between territories.
- Where customer service is important to an organisation.
- If the company wants to maintain control of its sales force but still needs a. (Any 3 × 2) (6)

2.3 2.3.1
- According to ledger account
- According to activity classification
- According to territories and products (3 × 1) (3)

2.3.2
- It enables management to compare input standards with output standards, determine reasons for deviations and take necessary corrective actions.
- Evaluation results can identify product lines or items that salespeople may be neglecting.
- To improve a salesperson's motivation and self-confidence.
- To assist salespeople to discover their strengths and weaknesses.
- To indicate to management what changes they should make to improve training programmes.
- To identify effective techniques used by successful salespeople and encourage less successful ones to try them. (Any 4 × 2) (8)

[50]

QUESTION 3

3.1
- There are no predetermined questions; candidates are entitled to talk freely on a variety of topics (open-ended).
- The questions mainly centre on the candidate's character, ability and career objective.
- It tests the ability of a candidate to think on his/her feet and react fast.
- It requires experience and a skilful interview that can follow a flexible approach to control the conversation with the minimum of direction.
- Example: 'Tell us about yourself.' (Any 4 × 2) (8)

3.2
- To verify information supplied in the application form with regard to qualifications and previous jobs.
- To obtain additional information about the candidate that could help the sales manager to form a more realistic perception. (2 × 2) (4)

3.3 3.3.1
- Straight salary
- Straight commission
- Combination plans (3 × 1) (3)

3.3.2
- Salespeople can be motivated to perform above the predetermined standards.
- Sales managers can use bonuses to encourage sales staff to work harder in performing nonsales tasks.
- Companies can offer bonuses to attract and keep good salespeople. (Any 2 × 2) (4)

3.3.3
- Progressive commission rate✓ – commission rate increases with an increase in sales.✓✓
- Regressive commission rate✓ – commission rate decreases with an increase in sales volume.✓✓
- Varied commission rate✓ – higher commission is paid for selling more profitable products and lower for selling less profitable products.✓✓ (3 × 3) (9)

3.4
- Testing trainees after they have completed a training programme.
- Evaluating trainees' sales performance against previously and agreed standards.
- One-one interviews with the trainees.
- Observing trainees while they perform their selling tasks.
- Asking customers about the performance of trainees with whom they have been in contact.
- Seeking the opinion of line and staff managers who were involved in their training.✓ (Any 5 × 2) (10)

3.5 3.5.1 Supervision is the process whereby a sales manager with the necessary authority and appropriate leadership style influences and controls the behaviour of a salesperson towards attainment of specific goals. (1 × 3)(Accept any other relevant answer) (3)

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3.5.2
- To limit costs of sales calls, including travelling and accommodation.
- To improve time management and assist salespeople to identify and avoid time-wasting habits.
- To direct the efforts of the sales force to deliver real results.
- To provide the necessary support when needed, e.g. dealing with complex deals.
- To meet the needs of the sales force to ensure that they remain motivated and encouraged daily to meet their objectives. (Any 3 × 2) (6)

3.3 On-the-job training occurs when a salesperson is performing his/her job under the supervision of a sales manager or supervisor over a period of time after which he/she will be assessed. (1 × 3)(Accept any other relevant answer) (3)

[50]

QUESTION 4

4.1 4.1.1 Product specialisation (2)

4.1.2
- Salespeople can gain in-depth product knowledge and become experts in their specific product group.
- Customers can benefit from expert advice.
- Each product line receives more management attention as the product/brand manager is responsible for a particular product group.
- Sales activities can be executed in a more focused manner along with other elements of marketing communication.
- Increased sales success means a better paid and more motivated sales force. (Any 3 × 2) (6)

4.1.3
- Sales force knowledge and experience.
- Sales managers' ability to supervise and control a larger number of sales people.
- Type of work that individuals perform.
- Time available for managing and supervising a sales force.
- Particular objectives and circumstances of the organisation.

(Any 5 × 2) (10)

4.2 In a decentralised sales organisation, authority and responsibility are delegated to lower levels of management. (2)

4.3
- Input standards are subjective and cannot be measured exactly, instead a salesperson's job activities are evaluated.
- Output standards are specific end results and are expressed in terms of exact quantities. (4)

4.4
4.4.1 Output
4.4.2 Input
4.4.3 Input
4.4.4 Output
4.4.5 Input

(5 × 2) (10)

4.5 4.5.1
- Sales staff/skills audit
- Direct approach
- Field observation
- Exit interviews
- Tests and assessments
- Researching the organisation's records (Any 5 × 2) (10)

4.5.2
- Knowledge of the company✓ – new sales staff should know the company's history, policies, procedures, vision and mission, new recruits should be introduced formally to other staff members, etc.✓
- Product knowledge✓ – know the origins, features, uses and benefits of the product.✓
- Knowledge of the selling process✓ – know the selling techniques and how to apply them correctly in different situations.✓
- Knowledge of the customers/market✓ – new sales staff must understand the characteristics of the customers, that is where they are found, types of customers, etc.✓
- Knowledge of the industry and competitors✓ – knowledge of the industry trends and characteristics, and understanding the competitors' products and their marketing strategies.✓

(Any 3 × 2) (6)
[50]

TOTAL SECTION B: 150
GRAND TOTAL: 200

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